

SDGs Alignment of Indonesia’s Research Strength

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Indonesia’s universities publish a great deal on the SDGs. The question is whether they publish on the goals their own provinces are failing.

METHOD

How alignment was measured

Supply and demand are ranked over the same 16 goals for each of the 34 provinces, then compared.

1	Supply	Scopus publication counts per SDG for 457 Indonesian universities, attributed to the province the university sits in. Each province's five strongest goals are its supply.
2	Measured demand	285 official indicator-dimensions from the National SDGs Secretariat, normalised and aggregated by principal component analysis into a 0–100 achievement index per goal. Each province's five weakest goals are its demand.
3	Stated demand	A survey of provincial Bappeda fielded 25 February – 14 March 2025 and answered by 27 of the 34 provinces — agency heads, division leaders and planners — setting out each province's own declared priorities, implementation constraints and existing university partnerships. Complemented by focus group discussions with local governments, universities and operating SDG Centers, and by content analysis of all 34 provincial RPJMDs.
4	Alignment	A goal on both the supply and demand lists is a match — a development gap the province's own universities are already strong in.

FIGURE 1

The goals universities publish on are not the goals provinces are failing

Number of provinces, out of 34, where each SDG is a top-five university strength and where it is a bottom-five achievement. Ordered by the size of the deficit.

Supply — a top-five university strength Demand — a bottom-five achievement

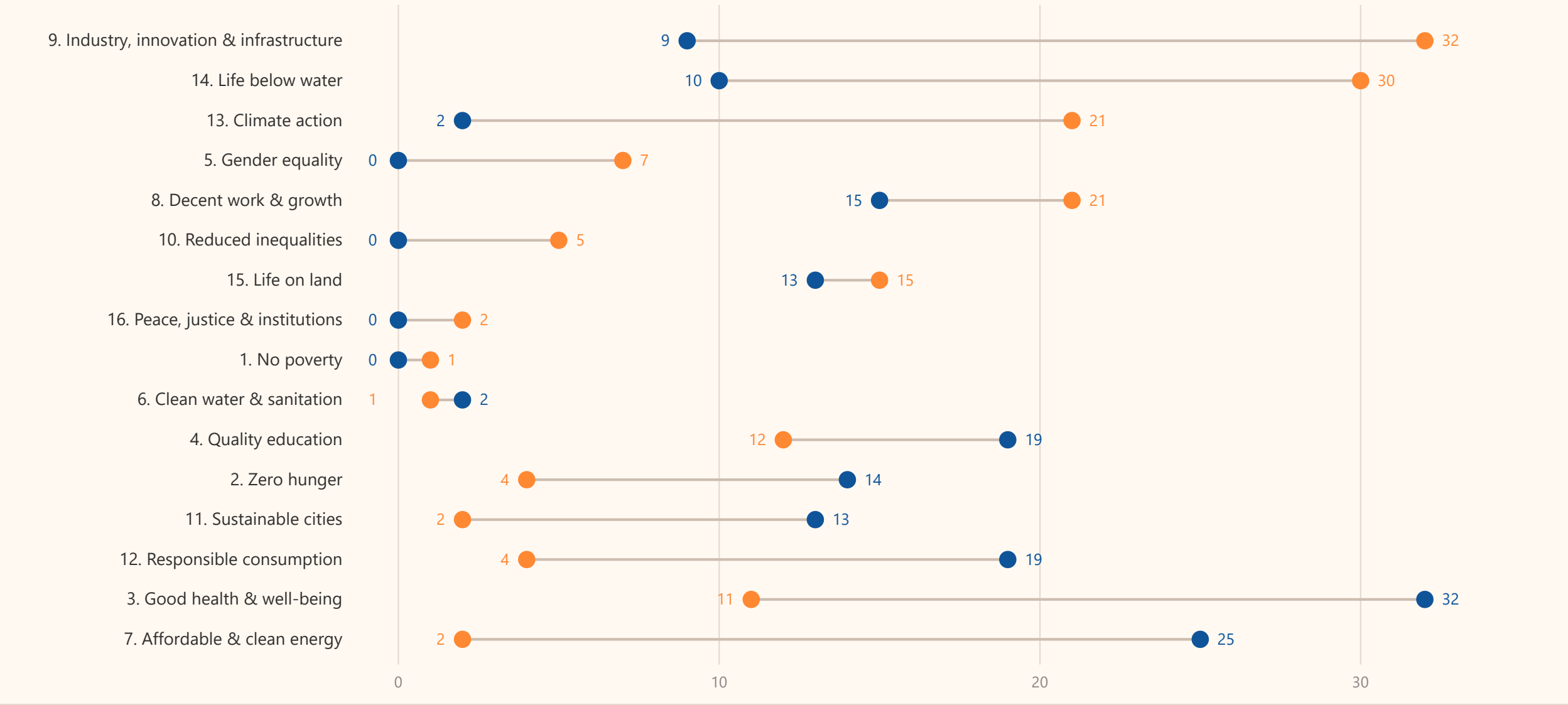
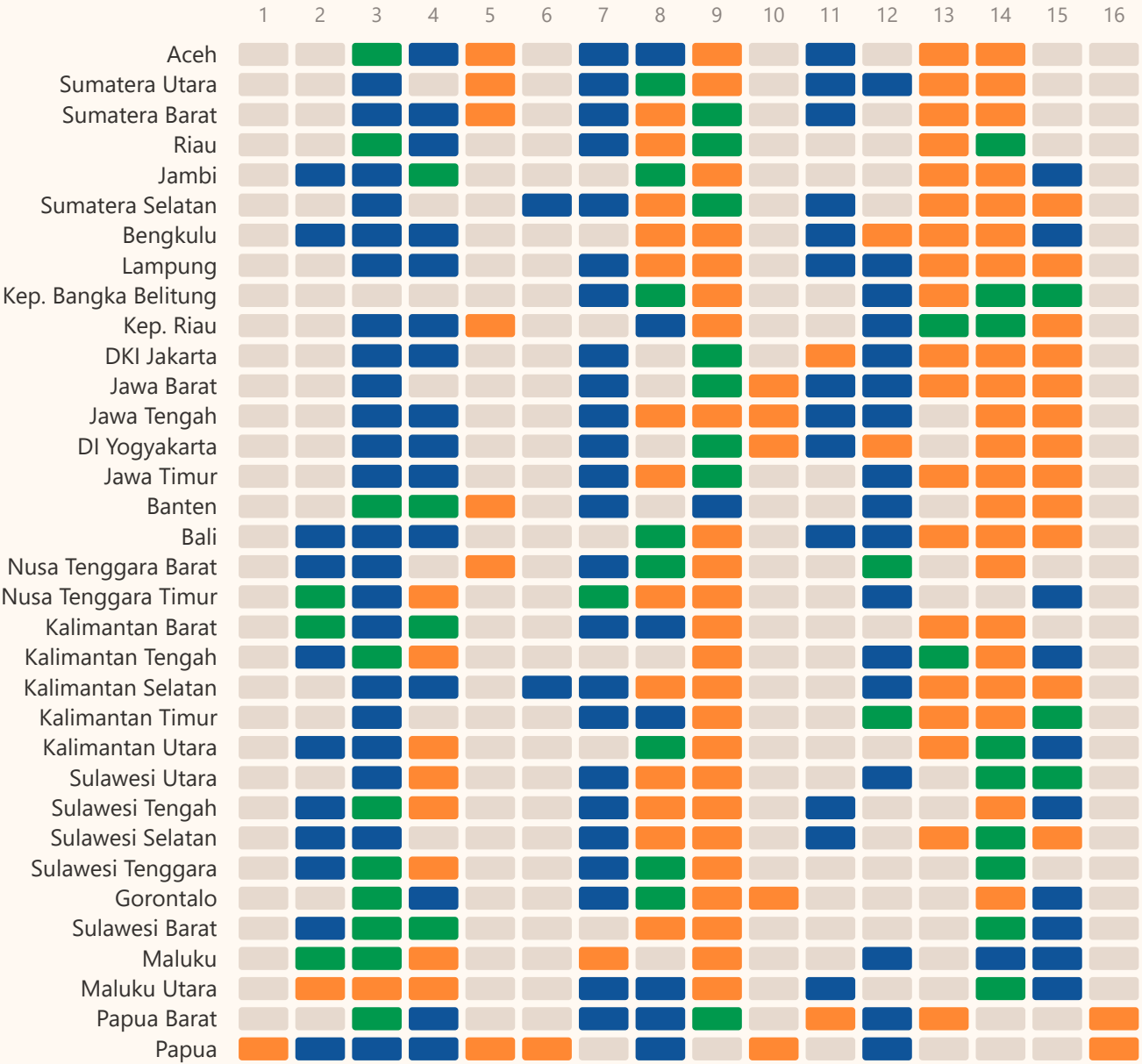


FIGURE 2

Province by province, goal by goal

Each row is a province, each column an SDG. Green is a match: a goal that is both one of the province's five strongest by publication and one of its five weakest by achievement.

Both — strength meets need Supply only Need only Neither



Source. *SDG Center Business Model — Final Report* (2025), prepared for the Asian Development Bank. Figures constructed from the report’s Table 4-22.

